WEEK 15: COMPREHENSIVE RELAPSE PREVENTION

Integrated Relapse Prevention Model

You've learned CBT skills (Weeks 1-8) and ACT principles (Weeks 9-14). Now it's time to integrate everything into a comprehensive relapse prevention plan.

This isn't just about stopping behavior. It's about building a sustainable recovery lifestyle.

REVIEW OF SKILLS FROM BOTH PHASES:

Phase 1 (CBT): Behavioral Management

- Understanding the CSBD cycle
- Identifying triggers
- Cognitive restructuring (challenging distorted thoughts)
- Urge surfing and coping strategies
- Self-compassion practices
- Communication and problem-solving skills

Phase 2 (ACT): Values-Based Living

- Acceptance of uncomfortable experiences
- Cognitive defusion (unhooking from thoughts)
- Values clarification
- Committed action despite discomfort
- Mindfulness practices
- Self-as-context (observer self)

The integrated approach uses BOTH sets of tools.

The Integrated Approach to Urges

When an urge appears, you now have a complete toolkit:

1. NOTICE (Mindfulness) Observe the urge without judgment. "An urge is present."

2. DEFUSE (ACT) "I'm having the thought that I need to act out" (not "I MUST act out")

3. ACCEPT (ACT) Make room for discomfort. Don't fight the urge, allow it.

4. CONNECT TO VALUES (ACT) What matters right now? What kind of person do I want to be?

5. CHALLENGE THOUGHTS (CBT) Check for cognitive distortions. What's the evidence?

6. USE COPING SKILLS (CBT) Implement specific strategies: urge surfing, opposite action, reach out, etc.

7. COMMIT TO ACTION (ACT) Do what aligns with values, regardless of how you feel.

Building a Recovery Lifestyle

Relapse prevention isn't just about managing urges. It's about building a life that supports recovery.

A recovery lifestyle includes:

PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Regular exercise (releases stress, improves mood)
- Adequate sleep (7-9 hours)
- Nutritious food (stable blood sugar, brain health)
- Limit alcohol and substances

EMOTIONAL REGULATION

- Ongoing therapy or counseling
- Regular mindfulness or meditation practice
- Journaling for self-awareness
- Healthy outlets for emotions

SOCIAL CONNECTION

- Strong support network
- Regular contact with accountability partners
- Support group attendance
- Healthy friendships
- Quality time with loved ones

SPIRITUAL PRACTICE (if valued)

- Prayer, meditation, or contemplation
- Connection to something larger than yourself
- Community involvement
- Service to others

MEANINGFUL WORK/PURPOSE

- Work that aligns with your values
- Contributing to something meaningful
- Growth and development
- Balance (not overworking as avoidance)

JOY AND RECREATION

- Hobbies and interests
- Play and leisure
- Creativity
- Adventure and exploration

EXERCISE 1: MY RECOVERY LIFESTYLE ASSESSMENT

Rate each area of your current lifestyle (1-10):

1 = Completely neglected | 10 = Thriving

Physical Health: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Emotional Regulation: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Social Connection: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Spiritual Practice: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Meaningful Work/Purpose: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Joy and Recreation: _____/10

What's working: _____

What needs improvement: _____

Which area needs the most attention?

One action I'll take this week to improve it:

Comprehensive Relapse Prevention Plan

Now it's time to create your complete relapse prevention plan. This document will be your roadmap for sustainable recovery.

PART 1: MY EARLY WARNING SIGNS

Review Week 8. List your top 5 warning signs:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

What I'll do when I notice these signs:

_____

_____

_____

_____

PART 2: MY HIGH-RISK SITUATIONS

Review Week 13. List your top 3 high-risk situations and action plans:

High-Risk Situation #1: _____

My action plan:

_____

_____

_____

High-Risk Situation #2: _____

My action plan:

_____

_____

_____

High-Risk Situation #3: _____

My action plan:

_____

_____

_____

PART 3: MY DAILY RECOVERY PRACTICES

What I will do EVERY DAY to maintain recovery:

Morning practice:

Evening practice:

Mindfulness/meditation: (How long? When?)

Physical activity: (What? When?)

Connection: (Who will I contact daily?)

Other daily practice:

PART 4: MY WEEKLY RECOVERY PRACTICES

What I will do EVERY WEEK to maintain recovery:

Support group/therapy: (Which? When?)

Accountability check-in: (With whom? When?)

Values review: (When will I review my values?)

Weekly planning: (When will I plan the week ahead?)

Self-care activity: (What? When?)

Other weekly practice:

PART 5: MY SUPPORT SYSTEM

Who I can call for support:

Name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Relationship: _____ **Best time to call:** _____

Name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Relationship: _____ **Best time to call:** _____

Name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Relationship: _____ **Best time to call:** _____

Professional support:

Therapist: _____ **Phone:** _____

Support group: _____ **Meeting time:** _____

Other: _____ **Contact:** _____

PART 6: MY EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN

When I'm in crisis (Red on the traffic light), I will:

STEP 1: Immediate action

STEP 2: Who I'll call

STEP 3: Where I'll go (if I need to leave)

STEP 4: What I'll do for the next hour

STEP 5: My reminder

"This urge will pass. I can handle discomfort. My values matter more than temporary relief. I am not my urges."

PART 7: MY VALUES REMINDER

Review Week 11. List your top 3-5 core values:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

My definition of sexual integrity:

_____

_____

_____

_____

PART 8: MY COMMITMENT

I commit to this recovery plan because:

_____

_____

_____

The life I'm building is worth:

_____

_____

_____

When I struggle, I will remember:

_____

_____

_____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Monthly Recovery Check-In

Recovery requires ongoing assessment and adjustment. Use this check-in monthly.

MONTH: _____ **YEAR:** _____

Overall recovery status: 🟢 Green | 🟡 Yellow | 🔴 Red

What's going well:

_____

_____

What's challenging:

_____

_____

Warning signs I've noticed:

_____

_____

Actions I need to take:

_____

_____

Support I need:

_____

Am I following my daily practices? Yes / No / Mostly

Am I following my weekly practices? Yes / No / Mostly

Do I need to adjust my plan? Yes / No

If yes, what adjustments:

_____

_____

_____

_____

When to Seek Additional Help

Recovery is ongoing. Know when you need more support.

Seek help immediately if:

- You're having suicidal thoughts
- You're in crisis and can't manage urges
- You're experiencing severe depression or anxiety
- You've had multiple lapses in a short period
- Your warning signs are escalating
- You're isolating completely
- You've stopped using all recovery practices

Seek help soon if:

- You're stuck at Yellow on the traffic light for more than a week
- Your support system isn't working
- You need more intensive treatment
- You're struggling with co-occurring issues (depression, anxiety, trauma)
- Your relationship is in crisis

Remember: Asking for help is strength, not weakness.

DAILY MONITORING LOG - WEEK 15

Continue your daily monitoring. This week, focus on integrating all your tools.

Additional tracking:

- What integrated approach did I use with urges?
- Am I following my daily recovery practices?
- What's my traffic light status?

[7 daily logs with same format as previous weeks—see Appendix A for blank forms]

WEEK 15 HOMEWORK CHECKLIST

Before moving to Week 16, complete:

- [ ] Read all Week 15 material
- [ ] Complete recovery lifestyle assessment
- [ ] Create complete relapse prevention plan (all 8 parts)
- [ ] Identify daily recovery practices
- [ ] Identify weekly recovery practices
- [ ] Finalize support system contacts
- [ ] Create emergency action plan
- [ ] Share plan with accountability partner or therapist
- [ ] Begin implementing daily/weekly practices
- [ ] Complete daily monitoring logs for all 7 days

Notes for Week 15:

END OF WEEK 15